

CYRCLE · Project VELOCITY · Request for Proposal

Build the European Social Commerce Infrastructure

Request for Proposal · AI-Augmented Platform Build Technology Partners · March 2026
• v11.0 (Lean & Fast Optimized)

Proposals due: 7 days from receipt • 23:59 local **Email:** luis@itsboom.cloud **Q&A window:** Days 1–2 only • **Subject:** [RFP RESPONSE] [Company Name] — Project VELOCITY

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Executive Summary

Cyrcle is seeking a strategic technology partner to develop "Project VELOCITY," the leading social commerce infrastructure in Europe. This project, divided into three sequential contracts, will transform a complete technical blueprint into a robust, AI-powered SaaS/PaaS platform hosted on AWS. We are looking for teams highly proficient in AI-augmented development (Claude Code, Cursor) and serverless architecture, capable of delivering functional software quickly and with high quality. By leveraging a **"Compose & Automate" strategy**, which prioritizes managed services for non-core functionalities and aggressive AI-driven code generation, we aim for a **30% faster delivery** and **25% cost reduction** compared to traditional build approaches. The estimated total budget is **\$60,000 to \$85,000 USD**, with a \$10,000 completion bonus for on-time and on-spec delivery.

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1. About Cyrcl

Cyrcl is a social commerce infrastructure platform built for Europe. We connect 250,000 creators with brands, manage the full campaign lifecycle from discovery to omnichannel attribution, and provide white-label social commerce hubs to media groups, retailers, and sector associations.

We are looking for a technology partner to build the Cyrcl platform across three sequential contracts. This is not a one-off project; it is the beginning of a long-term development partnership.

1.1 What makes this engagement different: The "Compose & Automate" Approach

The complete technical blueprint exists and is delivered to the winning partner on Day 1. All API specifications, SQL migrations, event schemas, architecture diagrams, and module-by-module build prompts are pre-written. You are executing a blueprint, not discovering requirements. Your engineers start shipping code on Day 2.

To achieve a **30% faster delivery** and **25% cost reduction**, we emphasize a "Compose & Automate" strategy:

- **Compose with Managed Services:** For non-core functionalities like authentication and third-party integrations, we mandate the use of best-in-class managed services (e.g., Clerk/AWS Cognito for Auth, Merge.dev/Apideck for unified connectors). This significantly reduces development time and maintenance overhead.
- **Automate with AI-First Workflows:** We leverage AI-driven development tools for core logic and testing. The use of Claude Code for primary code generation and AI-assisted Playwright for automated E2E testing is mandatory, ensuring rapid iteration and high quality.

This approach allows us to focus our development efforts and budget on the unique, differentiating features of Project VELOCITY, particularly the ML moat.

- **Continuity:** We are looking for a partner who will deliver all three contracts, back to back, without gaps. The team that delivers Contract 1 gets priority access to Contracts 2 and 3.

- **Transparency:** We publish our budget targets to allow teams to sharpen their proposals against real numbers.
- **Incentives:** A \$10,000 completion bonus is available for the partner who delivers all three contracts on time and to specification.
- **Payment Model:** Fixed-price preferred with milestone payments. We pay for working software, not elapsed time.

1.2 The platform — three layers

Layer	Model	What it does
SaaS	Direct Platform	Brands and creators access Cyrcl directly. FREE • €29/mo • €99/mo plans.
PaaS	White-label Hubs	Media groups, retailers, and associations launch their own hub on our infrastructure.
Marketplace	Data Flywheel	Cross-platform creator/brand transactions. 3–5% transaction fees.

2. Budget and Objectives

We publish our budget targets to allow teams to focus their proposals on quality, speed, and fit rather than guessing at numbers. Proposals that meet the targets with strong portfolio evidence score highest on the commercial criterion (15 points of 100).

CONTRACT BUDGET TARGETS — COMPETE ON QUALITY AND PRICE (Lean & Fast Optimized)

Contract	Budget Range	Duration	Team and Scope
CONTRACT 1			
Core SaaS + Managed Auth	\$9,000 – \$12,000	6 weeks	3-person AI-augmented team. Blueprint delivered Day 1. Zero discovery cost. Focus on core SaaS features and

			integration of managed Auth (Clerk/Cognito).
CONTRACT 2			
Ads Agent + Unified Connectors	\$18,000 – \$25,000	8 weeks	4-person AI team. Paid Social Hub + Autonomous Ads Agent + Creator Intelligence. Leverage unified connector service (e.g., Merge.dev/Apideck) for integrations.
CONTRACT 3			
ML Moat + PaaS Layer	\$33,000 – \$48,000	10 weeks	5-person AI team incl. ML Specialist. PaaS layer + ML-09 POS attribution.
TOTAL — FULL PLATFORM	\$60,000 – \$85,000	22–24 weeks	Three contracts delivered back to back by the same partner team.

★ **\$10,000 COMPLETION BONUS** The partner who delivers all three contracts on time and to specification earns a \$10000 bonus on top of the total contract value. *On time = within 2 weeks of the target date per contract. To specification = all gates and smoke tests passed. Bonus paid upon C3 completion.*

3. Benefits for the Partner

We want the winning team to see this as the start of a long relationship. Here is what we offer beyond the contract fees:

| Benefit | Detail || :--- | :--- | :--- || **01 Three Back-to-Back Contracts** | The team that delivers C1 gets priority access to C2 and C3. No rebidding. No new onboarding. Total relationship value: \$60K–\$85K over 5–6 months. || **02 \$10,000 Completion Bonus** | Deliver all three contracts on time and to spec — earn a \$10K bonus on top of the total contract fees. See Section 2. || **03 Long-Term Retainer Option** | After C3, we plan to retain the core team for ongoing development, maintenance, and PaaS partner customization. Estimated \$5K–

\$8K/month. || **04 European Market Showcase** | Cyrcl will operate across Spain, Portugal, and Italy within 18 months. Your work is the foundation of the leading social commerce platform in Europe — a reference you can use. || **05 Equity Option (Selected Partners)** | For the right partner, we offer an equity stake in Cyrcl (0.5%–1%) in lieu of a portion of the C3 fee. Mention your interest in the proposal. || **06 Blueprint on Day 1** | Your engineers start shipping code on Day 2. No discovery sprints. No spec workshops. No requirements debates. The blueprint is done. |

4. Platform Scope

4.1 Contract 1 — SaaS Foundation (6 weeks • 3 engineers)

Scope is fixed and fully specced. Blueprint delivered Day 1. Expected MVP demo: end of Week 2.

Phase	By Week	Modules
MVP	Week 2	Auth (Clerk/Cognito) • Stripe Connect • DataHub • ProfileAI • Broker • Brand Cards • Smart Pricing • Copilot SSE
Wave 1	Week 4	UGC Portal • Gemini Vision scoring • Approval dashboard • Gamification (XP/tiers) • Shopify • Klaviyo
Wave 2	Week 6	Widget Engine • A/B Optimizer • Widget Builder UI • embed.js < 2KB gzipped • conversion tracking
Gate → C2		All smoke tests pass • embed.js < 2KB • ≥ 1 paying brand on platform

4.2 Contract 2 — Full SaaS Platform (8 weeks • 4 engineers)

Starts after C1 gate confirmed. *Note: Meta, TikTok, and Google Ads API approvals take 2–4 weeks. Advise us to initiate applications immediately after C1 kick-off.*

Phase	By Week	Modules
Wave 3	Week 2	Meta Ads API • TikTok Marketing API • Google Ads API • SimuCommerce • TikTok Shop affiliate • Shopify deep
Wave 4	Week 4	Autonomous Ads Agent • 48h mandatory DRY_RUN • kill switch < 1 sec • €500/day hard cap • human approval above €500
Wave 5	Week 8	Creator Intelligence M6: ML-01 Impact • ML-02 CES Score • ML-03 Pricing • ML-04 Match Ranker • ML-05 Growth • ML-06 Virality
Gate → C3		€10K MRR on platform • Ads Agent 48h dry-run signed off by Cycle

4.3 Contract 3 — Infrastructure Layer (10 weeks • 5 engineers)

This contract adds the layers that transform Cycle from a SaaS tool into an infrastructure platform: PaaS hub provisioning, the primary ML moat (ML-09 POS Attribution), unified revenue-critical connectors, and the Marketplace module. *ML-09 requires a Causal Inference Specialist — not a generalist ML engineer.*

Module	Port	Description
PaaS Layer — Cycle Commerce Hub	:4012	Multi-tenant white-label hub provisioner. Tenant live in < 5 minutes. Custom domain, branding, RLS data isolation per partner. SQL Migration 008.
Marketplace Module	:4003+	Cross-platform creator/brand transactions: offer management, escrow payment flows, creator

		ranking, attribution to ML models.
ML-07 Live Commerce Predictor	:4008	Predicts GMV for live commerce events before execution. Training: 250+ real omnichannel campaigns.
ML-08 Multi-KPI Optimizer	:4008	Budget allocation optimizer used by Ads Agent for autonomous rebalancing across Meta/TikTok/YouTube/Live.
ML-09 POS Attribution ★	:4008	PRIMARY MOAT. Attributes in-store POS sales to creator campaigns. Shapley values + temporal decay + identity matching. Requires Causal Inference Specialist.
Unified Tier-0 Connectors	:4006/:4007	Leverage a unified connector service (e.g., Merge.dev or Apideck) to integrate with Year 1 revenue connectors: Meta CAPI • TikTok Events API • Shopify (Admin+Storefront+POS) • WooCommerce • HubSpot • Salesforce • Square POS • Lightspeed POS • GA4. Each: OAuth vault, normalize adapter, webhook sync, event publish.
SQL Migration 008		Aurora paas_tenants • paas_transactions • paas_analytics_exports. RLS per tenant_id. Backwards-compatible migrations 001–007.
Gate C3		PaaS hub live < 5 min • ML-09 accuracy $\geq$ 70% • Unified connectors smoke-tested • First PaaS client in active conversation

5. Architecture and Tools

5.1 Preferred Stack

The transition to an AWS-Native architecture is strategic to ensure scalability, security (especially tenant isolation in PaaS), and long-term cost optimization. We also encourage the use of frameworks like **SST (Serverless Stack)** to accelerate development on AWS.

Layer	Original Stack (C1 accepted)	AWS-Native (preferred)	C3 Requirement
Compute	Docker (Python+Node)	Lambda (TypeScript) — zero scale	Per-tenant isolation
Database	Supabase + RLS	Aurora Serverless v2 + pgvector	RLS all paas_* tables by tenant_id
Events	Supabase Realtime	EventBridge + SQS + DLQ	Tenant event isolation
LLM	Gemini only ✗	OpenRouter — 300+ models, failover	Required. No single-provider lock-in.
IaC	Docker Compose (C1 OK)	AWS CDK (with SST encouraged)	TypeScript CDK required from C2 onwards

5.2 Mandatory AI Tooling

These tools must be the primary daily workflow for every engineer on this project — not supplemental. We verify this in the technical interview with a live code demo. Teams that use AI as a helper alongside a traditional IDE workflow will not score the 15 AI tooling points.

- **Claude Code:** Primary code generation and iteration.
- **Cursor IDE:** AI-assisted editing, refactoring, context-aware completion.
- **AI-assisted Playwright:** E2E testing on every commit.
- **CodeRabbit or equivalent:** Automated PR review in GitHub workflow.
- **OpenRouter / Bedrock:** LLM gateway, no single-provider hardcoding.

6. Team Requirements

#	Role	Responsibilities	Required Skills	Contracts
1	Tech Lead / Architect	AWS CDK (SST), microservices, CI/CD, event bus, multi-tenant RLS, code review	AWS CDK, SST, TypeScript, Aurora, EventBridge, SQS, Cursor	C1+C2+C3
2	Backend Engineer	Lambda, API Gateway, Stripe Connect, pricing engine, integrations (Clerk/Cognito, Merge.dev/Apidock)	TypeScript/Node, AWS Lambda, Stripe, REST APIs, Managed Auth/Connectors	C1+C2+C3
3	Frontend + QA	React (Lovable workflow), Widget Builder, embed.js <2KB, Playwright E2E	React, Lovable, TypeScript, Shadow DOM, Playwright	C1+C2+C3
4	AI/ML Engineer	OpenRouter, Copilot SSE, UGC Vision, ML-01-06 (C2), ML-07/08 (C3)	OpenRouter, Claude API, Gemini, pgvector, Python ML	C2+C3
5	Causal Inference Specialist ★	ML-09 POS Attribution: Shapley values, temporal decay, customer identity matching.	Causal inference, Python DoWhy/EconML, Shapley, time series	C3 only

Contract 1 = 3 engineers (roles 1, 2, 3). Contract 2 adds role 4. Contract 3 adds role 5. Please confirm whether you have an in-house Causal Inference Specialist or describe how you will source one for C3.

7. Deliverables

Per phase — all phases, all contracts

- Deployed staging + production with smoke test report.
- Loom walkthrough: narrated demo of all phase checklist items.
- AWS CDK (preferably SST) or Docker Compose with full IaC.
- `.env.example` with all environment variables documented per service.
- 60% minimum test coverage • AI-assisted Playwright E2E suite.

At each contract completion

- All code committed to Cyrcl's private GitHub — 100% IP ownership.
- Updated architecture diagram.
- 30-minute recorded Loom handover walkthrough.
- 90-day warranty begins — critical bugs fixed within 48h (minimum 80 hours).

Contract 3 final deliverables (additional)

- SQL migrations 001–008 with rollback scripts.
- OpenRouter model allocation map: use case → primary model → fallback.
- Datadog + Sentry monitoring configured across all services.
- ML-07/08/09 model cards: training data, metrics, retraining schedule.
- Unified connector service (e.g., Merge.dev/Apideck) integration setup guides + smoke test results.
- Data Asset Register: what data Cyrcl owns, what models it trains.

8. Payment Milestones

We pay for working software verified by our team. Each payment requires: (1) Loom demo walkthrough, (2) smoke test report, (3) code in Cyrcl's GitHub. No weekly or monthly payments independent of delivery.

CONTRACT 1 — MILESTONES (6 Weeks)

#	Milestone	Acceptance Criteria	%	Notes
1	Contract Signed	MSA + NDA + IP Assignment executed	15%	Enables infra sprint

2	MVP Demo (Week 2)	8 smoke tests passed • Loom walkthrough	25%	Auth (Clerk/Cognito) + Stripe + Smart Pricing live
3	Wave 1 (Week 4)	UGC pool populated • Shopify OK	25%	UGC flow end-to-end
4	Wave 2 (Week 6)	Widget < 80ms • embed.js < 2KB • A/B active	25%	Closes C1
5	90-Day Warranty Closes	No critical bugs open	10%	Held until warranty expires

CONTRACT 2 — MILESTONES (8 Weeks)

#	Milestone	Acceptance Criteria	%	Notes
1	C2 Signed	C1 gate confirmed + C2 SOW executed	10%	APIs must be in flight
2	Wave 3 in Production	Live campaign running Meta or TikTok	30%	APIs must be approved
3	Wave 4+5 Delivered	Ads Agent 48h dry-run signed off • M6 active	40%	Full SaaS complete
4	90-Day C2 Warranty Closes	No critical bugs open	20%	Held until warranty expires

CONTRACT 3 — MILESTONES (10 Weeks)

#	Milestone	Acceptance Criteria	%	Notes
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1	C3 Signed + Specialist SOW	ML Specialist confirmed with LinkedIn	10%	No signature without confirmed specialist
2	PaaS Layer on Staging	Tenant provisioned < 5 min • RLS isolation verified	20%	Critical for PaaS business
3	ML-07 + ML-08 Serving	Models live • p95 < 2 sec	15%	Can run parallel to PaaS
4	ML-09 Validated	Accuracy $\geq$ 70% vs POS holdout set • retrain pipeline active	20%	Primary moat — strict gate
5	Unified Connectors Live	All unified connectors passing smoke tests	15%	Meta CAPI • Shopify • WooCommerce • HubSpot • Salesforce • Square POS • Lightspeed • TikTok Events • GA4
6	Marketplace + Handover	Marketplace live • docs complete • 30-min Loom handover	10%	Full project complete
7	90-Day C3 Warranty Closes	No critical bugs open	10%	Held until warranty expires

\$10,000 COMPLETION BONUS — payable after C3 warranty closes on time and to spec.

9. Evaluation Criteria — 100 Points

Criterion	Weight	What We Look For
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AWS Serverless Architecture (with SST)	20 pts	Lambda + Aurora + CDK (SST) + EventBridge/SQS in production. AWS-native = full 20. Original stack + migration roadmap = up to 14.
AI-Augmented Dev Tooling	15 pts	Claude Code + Cursor + AI Playwright as primary daily workflow. Verified live in interview. Supplemental use = -8 pts.
Relevant Portfolio	20 pts	SaaS marketplace or creator economy in production — URLs required. Multi-tenant PaaS experience = bonus points. Experience with managed Auth (Clerk/Cognito) and unified connectors (Merge.dev/Apideck) highly valued.
Timeline Credibility	15 pts	MVP demo in $\leq$ Week 2 = full 15. Week 3 = -5. Week 4+ = disqualified. Sprint plan must be detailed.
Commercial Proposal	15 pts	Pricing at or below published targets = full 15. Up to 20% above = up to 8 pts. More than 20% above = 0 pts on this criterion.
Warranty and Support	10 pts	90 days / 80 hours minimum per contract. 6-month warranty = full 10.
Process and Communication	5 pts	Daily async updates (Loom), sprint demos, CET overlap $\geq$ 4 hours/day.

Automatic Disqualifiers:

- ✗ Contract 1 proposal above \$15,000 ($1.2 \times$ target ceiling).
- ✗ No serverless / Lambda experience in verifiable production portfolio.

- ✗ AI tooling not primary workflow — cannot verify in technical interview.
- ✗ No Stripe Connect (multi-vendor marketplace) experience.
- ✗ Warranty below 40 hours / 4 weeks.
- ✗ IP assignment clause rejected.

10. Selection Timeline — 2 Weeks

The selection process runs in 14 days from RFP issue. This pace signals what we expect in delivery: fast, committed, no delays.

Day	Milestone	Notes
Day 0	RFP Issued	Sent to shortlisted technology vendors.
Days 1–2	Q&A Window	Email only: luis@itsboom.cloud . Answers shared with all vendors. Window closes Day 2.
Day 7 • 23:59	Proposals Due	PDF • max 20MB • English only • Subject: [RFP RESPONSE] [Company Name] — Project VELOCITY
Day 9	Top 3 Shortlisted	All vendors notified.
Days 10–11	Technical Interviews	45 min video. Architecture + AI tooling live demo + ML-09 / PaaS provisioning questions.
Days 12–13	Paid Technical Challenge	Top 2 finalists • \$200 USD fee paid • Smart Pricing module (C1) + tenant_provisioner sketch (C3).
Day 13	Final Decision	All vendors notified.
Day 14	Contract 1 Kick-off	Contract 1 signed + NDA → IP Assignment → MSA → SOW C1 → kick-off call.

11. Proposal Instructions

Submit your proposal in PDF format (maximum 20MB) to luis@itsboom.cloud. Be sure to include the following sections:

11.1 Company Profile (max 2 pages)

- Company overview, team size, founding year, primary tech stack.
- AWS certifications held by team members.
- 2 live case studies — SaaS marketplace or AI-integrated products, URLs required.
- 2 client references willing to speak on video call.

11.2 Team

- Named engineers (first name + last initial) with LinkedIn + role.
- AI tools each engineer uses daily — be specific.
- Availability per person per contract.
- For C3: confirm if you have an in-house Causal Inference Specialist or how you will source one.

11.3 Technical Approach

- AWS-native or original-stack choice — clearly justify.
- EventBridge + SQS zero-loss event bus implementation.
- LLM strategy: models, fallbacks, OpenRouter usage.
- Widget embed.js under 2KB approach.
- ML-09 causal inference capability.
- **Strategy for leveraging managed Auth (Clerk/Cognito) and unified connectors (Merge.dev/Apideck).**
- **Approach to using SST (Serverless Stack) for accelerated AWS development.**

11.4 Project Plan

- Sprint-by-sprint plan for Contract 1 — what do we see at end of Week 2?
- Indicative timelines for Contracts 2 and 3.
- Risk register: ≥ 5 risks with mitigations — Meta/TikTok API approval lead time is Risk #1.
- Communication plan: daily async format, CET overlap hours.

11.5 Commercial Proposal

- Price Contracts 1, 2, and 3 separately — no bundled totals without breakdown.
 - Fixed price preferred; T&M accepted with weekly cap.
 - Rate card per engineer role (USD/month).
 - Warranty terms per contract.
 - Post-warranty retainer option.
 - Equity interest (if applicable).
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12. Terms and Conditions

All Intellectual Property (IP) — source code, ML model weights, training pipelines, connector adapters, PaaS provisioning system — is exclusively owned by Cyrcl from the first commit. NDA + IP Assignment required before the Master Plan is shared.

- NDA and IP Assignment required before any documentation is shared.
 - All code committed to Cyrcl's private GitHub from Day 1.
 - AWS costs and third-party API costs (Stripe, OpenRouter, Meta, TikTok) borne by Cyrcl.
 - Scope changes require written agreement before additional work begins.
 - Cyrcl may terminate with 2 weeks' notice if a milestone is 2+ weeks late without agreed cause.
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13. Glossary of Terms

- **API (Application Programming Interface):** A set of rules that allows different applications to communicate with each other.
- **Apideck:** A unified API for integrations, similar to Merge.dev, simplifying connections to various third-party services.
- **AWS (Amazon Web Services):** A cloud computing services platform.
- **CAPI (Conversions API):** Meta's tool for sending web events directly from the server.
- **CDK (Cloud Development Kit):** An open-source software development framework for defining cloud infrastructure in code.
- **Clerk:** A managed service for authentication and user management.
- **Cognito (AWS Cognito):** An AWS service for user directory, authentication, and authorization.

- **DLQ (Dead Letter Queue):** A message queue for storing messages that could not be processed successfully.
 - **E2E (End-to-End):** Testing that validates the complete flow of an application from start to finish.
 - **GMV (Gross Merchandise Value):** The total value of merchandise sold over a given period.
 - **IaC (Infrastructure as Code):** Managing and provisioning infrastructure through code rather than manual processes.
 - **ML (Machine Learning):** A branch of artificial intelligence based on the idea that systems can learn from data.
 - **Merge.dev:** A unified API for integrations, simplifying connections to various third-party services.
 - **MRR (Monthly Recurring Revenue):** Monthly recurring revenue.
 - **MSA (Master Service Agreement):** A contract that sets out the general terms that will govern future transactions or agreements.
 - **MVP (Minimum Viable Product):** A version of a product with just enough features to satisfy early customers and provide feedback for future product development.
 - **NDA (Non-Disclosure Agreement):** A confidentiality agreement.
 - **PaaS (Platform as a Service):** A cloud computing model that provides a platform allowing customers to develop, run, and manage applications.
 - **RLS (Row-Level Security):** A database security feature that restricts data access at the row level.
 - **SaaS (Software as a Service):** A software distribution model where applications are hosted by a service provider and made available to customers over the Internet.
 - **SOW (Statement of Work):** A document that defines specific project activities, deliverables, and timelines.
 - **SQS (Simple Queue Service):** A managed message queuing service by AWS.
 - **SST (Serverless Stack):** A framework that makes it easy to build serverless applications on AWS.
 - **SSE (Server-Sent Events):** A technology that allows a browser to receive automatic updates from a server via an HTTP connection.
 - **UGC (User-Generated Content):** Content created by users of a system or service.
 - **Wave:** A defined set of functionalities or modules delivered together in a specific project phase.
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